Form Your Team

Our Team Canvas

Team _____ Date _____

1 Why are we here?

Our purpose

Why do we exist, and for whom?

Our future

What does success look like in three years?

2 Who are we?

What does each of us bring, and how do we work at our best?

3 How do we work?

When do we plan, make and review?

4 How do we make decisions?

Which decision do we make often, and how will we make it?

5 How do we want to be together?

IN

Behaviour we practise

OUT

Behaviour we don't accept

6 How do we learn and reform?

Keep

Change

Try

One post-it per idea · Any order · © Michael Heider · CC BY-NC-SA 4.0

1 Why are we here?

Explain it to a friend

In pairs, explain why the team exists as if to a friend over dinner. The listener writes down phrases that feel clear and human, one per post-it.

Pairs · 25 min

Words that felt clear and human

Put the post-its here, then group what keeps coming back.

Our purpose

Use the strongest words.

We exist to

for

so that

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1 Why are we here?

In three years' time...

Everyone writes two or three endings to the sentence, one per post-it. Group similar ones, then vote for the one that feels true, not just ambitious.

Alone, then together · 30 min

In three years' time, this team will have...

Post-its here. Group them, then give everyone three dots to vote.

Our picture of success

The one we chose, refined together.

Signs it is becoming real

Two or three things we would notice.

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2 Who are we?

Personal user manual

Everyone writes one post-it per question, with their initials, and sticks it in the right box. Then share in pairs: one question to understand, not to challenge.

Alone, then pairs · 20 min

You get the best from me when...

I struggle when...

I prefer feedback that...

Under pressure I may...

Some of my quirks are...

You can rely on me for...

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2 Who are we?

Skills marketplace

Everyone writes three things they can offer and one they want to grow in, with their initials. Read them out, then pair people up.

Alone, then together · 30 min

I can offer

Three post-its each.

I want to grow in

One post-it each.

Pairs to try

Who learns from whom in the next few weeks?

_____ ↔ _____ _____ ↔ _____ _____ ↔ _____ _____ ↔ _____

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3 How do we work?

Draw your team’s loop

Put the meetings and habits you already have on the loop, one per post-it. Keep what helps, drop what doesn’t, and agree when each moment happens.

Whole team · 30 min

Plan

When and how do we plan?

Make

When and how do we make?

Review

When and how do we review?

back to plan

We drop

Meetings and habits that don’t help

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4 How do we make decisions?

Choose how to decide

Write the decisions that keep coming back, one per post-it, and agree on one. Pick one of the twelve ways to make it, try it, then look back.

Whole team · 30 min

Decisions we make again and again

Circle the one that matters most.

Twelve ways to decide

NARROW DOWN OPTIONS

- [ ] **Dot voting** A long list of ideas needs a shortlist, fast.
- [ ] **Multi-voting** One round of votes is too scattered to show a favourite.
- [ ] **Scoring matrix** Every option has its own trade-offs.

DECIDE QUICKLY

- [ ] **Majority vote** There are two options and either would work.
- [ ] **Plurality** There are several options and no time for more rounds.
- [ ] **Authority** One person is accountable for the outcome.

BRING EVERYONE ALONG

- [ ] **Fist to five** People seem to agree, but you can't tell if they really do.
- [ ] **Consensus** Everyone needs to support the decision to carry it out.
- [ ] **Consent** You need to move on, even if it isn't everyone's first choice.

SETTLE WHO HAS THE FINAL SAY

- [ ] **Supermajority** A big decision needs more than a narrow win.
- [ ] **Unanimity** Every person must actively agree before you move.
- [ ] **Delegation** The whole team doesn't need to weigh in every time.

We will try

This way, for this decision.

How did it feel?

Keep it, or try another?

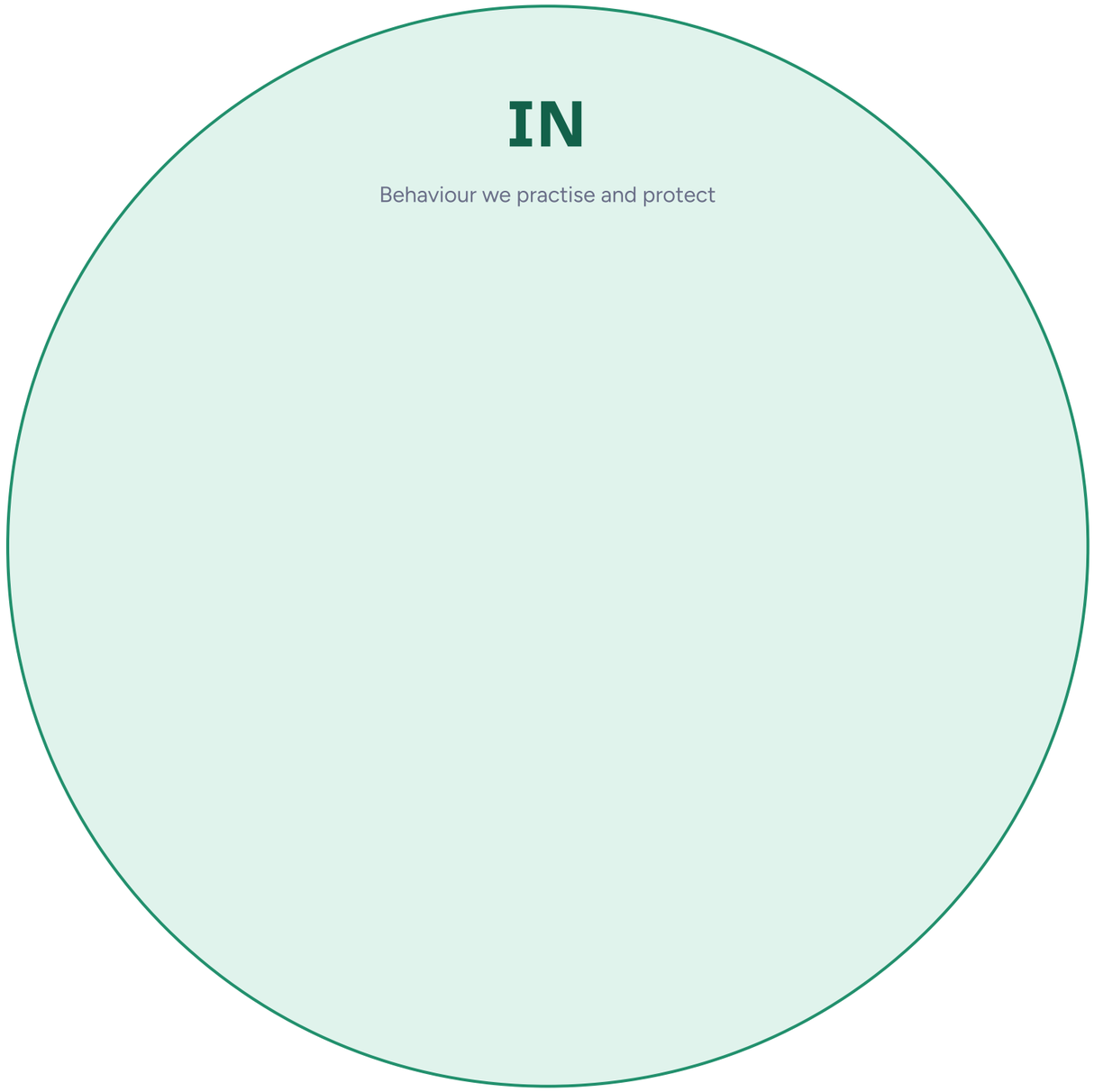
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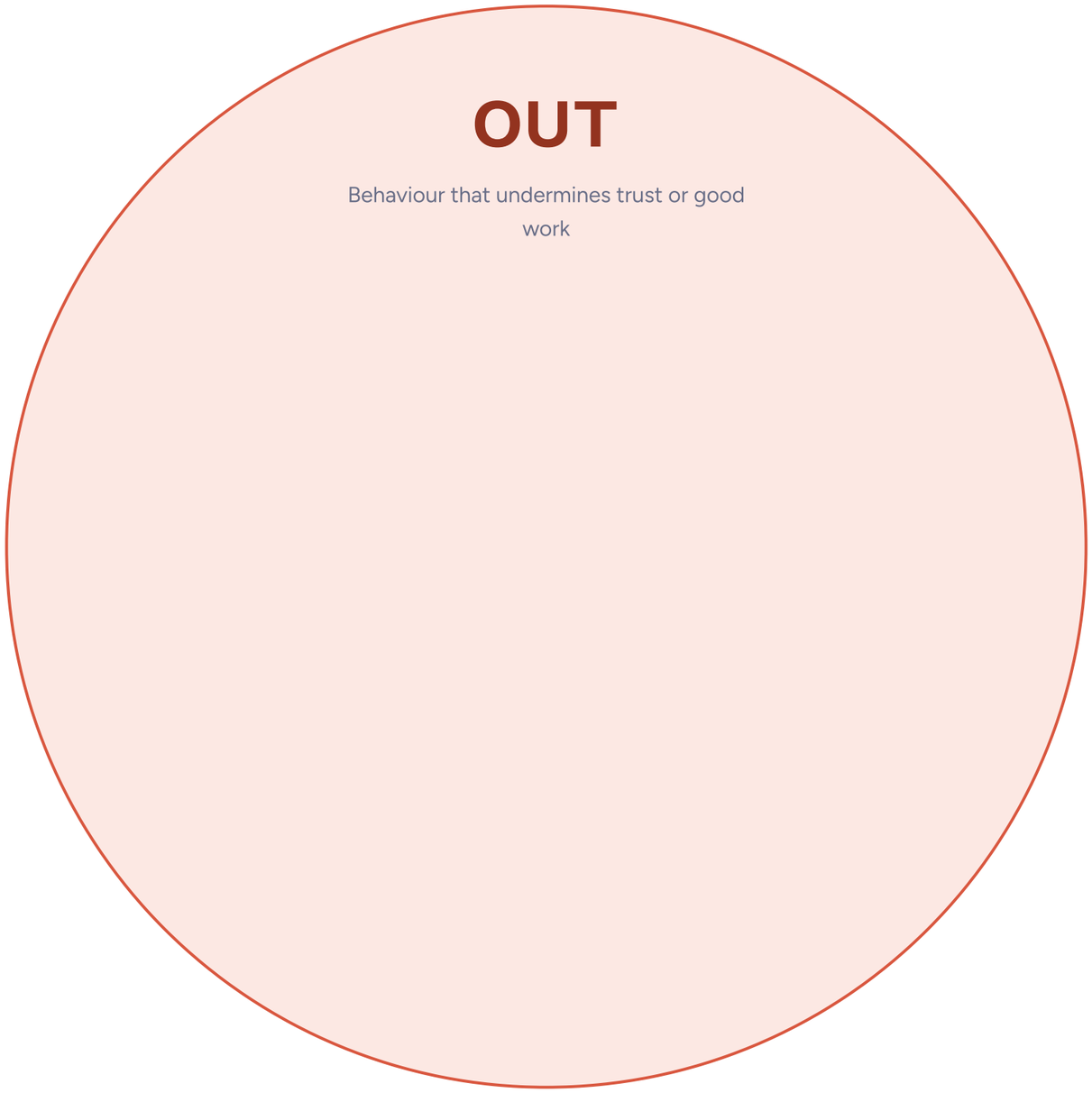
5 How do we want to be together?

The two-circle team contract

One behaviour per post-it, written so anyone could see it. Stick it in IN or OUT, then combine similar ones.

Whole team · 45 min





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6 How do we learn and reform?

Keep / Change / Try

One idea per post-it. Agree one small experiment, and what should make you sit down with the canvas again.

Whole team · 30 min

Keep

What should we protect?

Change

What is no longer helping us?

Try

What small experiment will we run next?

We sit down with the canvas again when...

For example: someone joins or leaves, or our purpose changes.

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